

Cases and Variables

MATH 213

Cases and Variables

- **Cases** are the people or objects about which we are collecting data.

Example: The cases in the covid vaccination dataframe are the countries.

- A **variable** is any characteristic that is recorded for each case.

Example: Population and Income group are examples of variables in the covid vaccination dataframe.

- In a **dataframe**, the cases label the rows and the variables label the columns. Data organized in this way are called **tidy data**.

Categorical and Numerical Variables

A **categorical variable** divides the cases into groups or categories.

Example:

- *Income group*
- *Whether the country had above-or below-average vaccination rates*

are categorical variables in the covid vaccination dataframe.

A **numerical (or quantitative)** variable measures a numerical quantity for which it makes sense to perform calculations such as taking an average, for example.

Example:

- *Population*
- *Share of delivered doses used*

are examples of numerical variables in the covid vaccination dataframe.